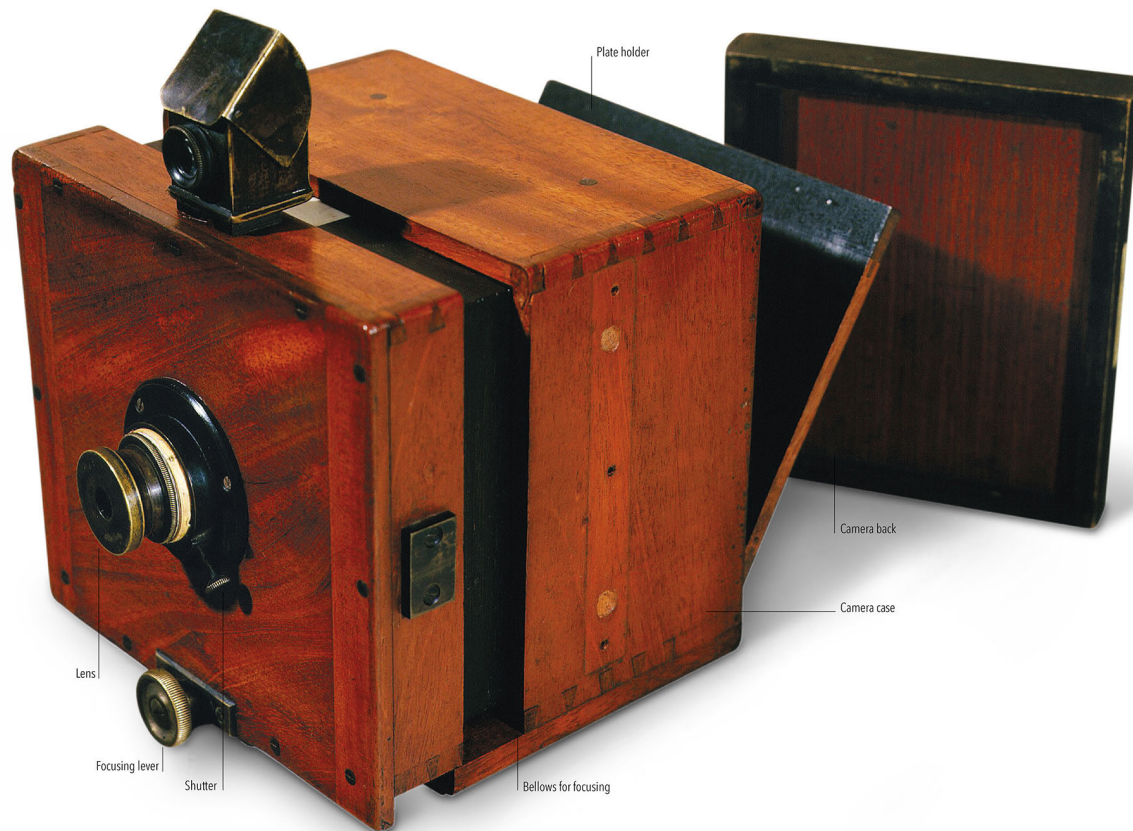




Wet-plate camera

A mahogany-encased wet-plate camera of Civil War vintage. After a sensitized glass plate was inserted into the plate holder, the holder would be slotted into the back of the camera and the lens focused with the focusing lever.

Field activity

Brady's access to the war was not exclusive. Other photographers were active, some under contract to the government. Captain Andrew Russell shot the railroads, trestle bridges, and supply depots of the Railroad Construction Corps, as well as military burials, gun emplacements, and the burned ruins of Richmond. Still others were employed at Union headquarters, photographing maps and plans for distribution to staff officers.

In the South, A. D. Lytle of Louisiana worked for the Confederate Secret Service, slyly documenting Union activities in occupied Baton Rouge. He was among those Southern photographers—including George Smith Cook, called the “Photographer of the Confederacy” for the range of his coverage—